2.4.2 Start small and incrementally

Once you've secured buy-in from at least two teams, it's advisable to begin implementing contract testing gradually. A good starting point is to add one new test or convert an existing integration test to a contract test. In chapter 4 and onward, we'll provide detailed explanations of the technical implementation process, guiding you on how to write contract tests, both on the consumer and provider perspective, and integrate them into your CI pipelines.

When introducing contract testing, it's essential to consider the complexity and nature of the APIs or data services you're working with. In work projects, it's very common to work with more than one API or data service. If you're dealing with numerous data services, it may be more straightforward to begin by introducing contract testing to a brand-new API rather than starting with a legacy API that may pose more significant testing challenges. Starting with a simpler, less complex scenario allows you to familiarize yourself with the process and gain confidence before tackling more complex systems.

Chapter 10 will delve into the setup required to establish a fully automated contract testing process within your CI pipelines. It's important to note that this setup may involve various configurations and integrations that could take some time. To ensure a smooth transition and avoid overwhelming the team, we advise starting incrementally, even if it means triggering the contract testing job manually in the initial stages from both the consumer and provider pipelines.

Taking an incremental approach allows you to gradually build up your contract testing infrastructure, gain experience, learn from any mistakes, and address any challenges that could arise. It gives you the opportunity to validate the effectiveness of contract testing in your specific context and make necessary adjustments along the way.

2.4.3 Communicate benefits and progress visibly

To increase buy-in and support for contract testing, it's crucial to communicate the benefits clearly to stakeholders and decision-makers.